

# Interview Thesis Brief

PMI · Senior Manager, Business Process Excellence

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## MANDATE HYPOTHESIS

Build an enterprise mechanism that turns cross-functional process friction into a governed portfolio of redesign interventions, separates necessary local variation from process debt, clarifies end-to-end ownership and decision rights, and proves whether redesigned work creates sustained business value.

## COMPANY MOMENT

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Portfolio transformation</b><br><br>PMI reports that its smoke-free business generated 43% of total global net revenues in Q1 2026, with more than 43 million estimated legal-age consumers across 108 markets. | <b>Transformation system</b><br><br>PMI describes transformation as powered by science, data, digital innovation, human judgment, and responsible decision-making. |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## OPERATING TENSIONS

|                                                                                                             |                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Global vs local</b><br><br>Standardize enough to scale without flattening regulatory and market reality. | <b>Speed vs traceability</b><br><br>Transform quickly while preserving control logic and evidence. |
| <b>Ambition vs capacity</b><br><br>Prioritize against finite organizational change bandwidth.               | <b>Visibility vs adoption</b><br><br>Data exposes friction; routines determine behavior.           |
| <b>End-to-end vs function</b><br><br>Own outcomes without creating parallel bureaucracy.                    |                                                                                                    |

## WHITE-SPACE THESIS

**Business Process Excellence should behave like a Process Genome:** define the stable core, make legitimate variants explicit, detect harmful mutations, and evolve standards from evidence.

## STRONGEST OBJECTION

**Concern:** Russell has no direct tobacco/nicotine background. **Response:** acknowledge the gap, then make the adjacent-evidence argument across transformation, manufacturing and quality systems, high-reliability operations, regulated aviation, 24/7 logistics, and AI-enabled workflow design.

# Thesis Brief · Proof & Discussion

## Process excellence as a living enterprise system

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### PROOF MAP

| Evidence    | Verified fact                                                                           | Role relevance                                         |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Vape-Jet    | Current AI-first operating transformation across business functions and systems.        | Direct redesign, handoffs, visibility, and adoption.   |
| Amazon      | 24/7 mechanisms supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.       | Scale, cadence, flow, ownership, escalation.           |
| Compunetics | High-reliability engineering, manufacturing, quality systems, controls, and root cause. | Technical/business translation and control discipline. |
| DudeWorth   | AI-readiness and agentic workflow patterns with human judgment and governance rails.    | AI tied to work, economics, governance, and adoption.  |

### FIRST 120 DAYS

|                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>0–30 · Decode</b><br><br>Stakeholder map, taxonomy, two pilots, baseline scorecard, variant and exception inventory.            | <b>31–60 · Make variation explicit</b><br><br>Process Genome maps, process contracts, decision rights, controls, and system seams. |
| <b>61–90 · Run targeted trials</b><br><br>Hypothesis-led interventions with outcome, flow, risk, economics, and behavior evidence. | <b>91–120 · Institutionalize learning</b><br><br>Portfolio governance, owner cadence, benefit validation, and scaling rules.       |

### EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

- Where does PMI currently feel transformation friction most?
- Which processes have true enterprise owners?
- How does PMI distinguish required variation from process debt?
- How are improvement benefits validated and sustained?
- What decision authority does this role hold directly?
- Where is process excellence experienced as overhead?

### RESEARCH BASIS

Official PMI corporate site and Q1 2026 progress indicators; PMI Value Report 2025 hub; PMI Careers overview; PMI 'The human edge in the age of AI.' The original job URL is preserved, but its body remained unavailable; no JD-specific responsibility or qualification was invented.